

PERCUSSION / PRODUCT DOSSIER

Pedal timpani

TP-300 Roundwave

Stonebridge Works / line P1



Figure 1. AI-generated illustration of the fictional flagship; not a specification photograph.

Synthetic training corpus. The company, factories, models, performers, events, measurements and commercial records are fictional. Generated images are illustrative, not engineering drawings.

02 / A workshop history, not a generic instrument

04 / Stonebridge Works owns the complete build route

06 / Choose, maintain and service a known configuration

08 / Models and shipments

03 / The player problem shapes the flagship

05 / Acceptance measures function, not prestige

07 / External anatomy

09 / Production route

01 / HISTORY

A workshop history, not a generic instrument

The pedal timpani occupies a distinct place in the Aster Vale Instruments catalogue. The company was founded in 1958 as a fictional repair workshop and gradually became a manufacturer. Its first model in this instrument family appeared in 1994, rather than at the company's founding. Today production belongs to Stonebridge Works, line P1. That assignment identifies the responsible workshop, not a retailer or a place where a famous performance happened. All names and records in this dossier belong to the synthetic Aster Vale setting.

The broader instrument tradition provides context rather than a claim of invention. Our design draws on orchestral kettledrums and the later pedal systems that permit rapid pitch changes. In the current instrument, a pedal changes membrane tension over a resonant bowl, shifting pitch while the head and bowl shape the decay. Aster Vale did not invent that operating principle. Its contribution in this catalogue is a particular production and service approach: the calibrated balance cartridge that separates pedal counterforce adjustment from head-tension adjustment. A buyer comparing brands should distinguish an established acoustic principle from a model-specific construction detail.

The 1994 TP-90 used a hand-tensioned copper bowl. A 2007 orchestral trial established the balanced pedal frame. The 2015 TP-210 introduced a calibrated balance cartridge. Roundwave launched in 2021 with revised bowl-rim support. In 2025 the final test added a hold interval at both ends of the specified pitch range. These events explain why the current flagship looks and behaves as it does. They are internal milestones in the fictional company's history, not dates for the invention of the instrument itself. Earlier instruments remain eligible for assessment, but a modern replacement part is not assumed to fit an older production series merely because the family name is the same.

The current range consists of TP-100 Foundation, TP-200 Atelier and TP-300 Roundwave. Foundation is the access model, Atelier adds individual fitting time, and the 300-series flagship receives the longest voicing and final assessment. None is a miniature or a different instrument family. The shared nominal head diameter (mm) is 660 across these three standard configurations. A dealer must not infer a shorter scale or smaller cabinet from the lower price.

The design compromise is deliberate: a light frame helps touring crews but must remain rigid enough to keep bowl support and pedal geometry consistent. The company therefore avoids describing one material or one number as a universal quality score. An instrument can pass its dimensional specification and still require a setup suited to the player. Conversely, a player may prefer a lower-priced configuration because its response fits a particular room, technique or transport routine. The model ladder is a selection aid, not a ranking of musicians.

The history also explains our service policy. The documented repair emphasis is head replacement and pedal-balance calibration, supported by a serial-based parts record. Changes made in a later revision are not quietly attributed to an earlier model. A repairer records whether the instrument remains in its original configuration or has received an approved update. That distinction matters when a performer, dealer and workshop discuss the same instrument using different informal names.

02 / PERFORMERS

The player problem shapes the flagship

In the fictional Aster Vale music scene, Petra Flint is the best-known advocate of TP-300 Roundwave. The performer works with The Bellwater Orchestra and used the model for the fictional 2024 Roundwave festival. This is an invented endorsement within the training setting, not a claim about a real artist. The useful part of the story is the playing requirement: a pitch change that settles quickly without a pedal creeping back. That requirement gives a concrete reason to discuss response rather than relying on a decorative celebrity name.

The session brief asked the workshop to preserve that musical outcome at both rehearsal and performance levels. The technician began with the standard instrument, documented the player's setup and changed only one variable at a time. The team did not turn an artist's preference into a new factory limit. The release specification remained the same; the performer record described the adjustments and accessories used for this particular engagement.

A second fictional performer, Emil Brook, uses this family for conservatory percussion ensemble work. The two stories are intentionally different. A setting that supports the first brief may not be ideal for the second. A dealer should therefore ask about venue, ensemble, typical dynamics and maintenance access before recommending the flagship. The correct question is which response the player needs, not which performer has the most recognizable name.

Our comparison passage starts gently, reaches the player's normal performance level and returns to a quiet ending. The listener pays attention to onset, continuity and decay, not simply maximum loudness. The player repeats the passage on Foundation, Atelier and TP-300 Roundwave, with rest between attempts. The sequence can be reversed to reduce the influence of fatigue or expectation. A higher list price is not revealed as a cue before the listening comparison.

The flagship's characteristic serviceable feature is the calibrated balance cartridge that separates pedal counterforce adjustment from head-tension adjustment. In the artist programme, the workshop explains what this feature does and what it does not do. It supports repeatable construction or service, but it does not replace musical technique. It also does not guarantee a particular recorded tone in an unknown room. The performer remains responsible for the artistic choice; the workshop remains responsible for the documented instrument condition.

An artist loan is checked before dispatch and again on return. The record includes the serial, model revision, accessories, visible condition and the agreed setup. Changes made on tour are recorded rather than silently reset. The celebrated performance establishes a narrative about use, while the return inspection establishes the physical condition of that instrument. Neither replaces the production acceptance checks described in the quality section of this dossier.

03 / MANUFACTURING

Stonebridge Works owns the complete build route

Production of the pedal timpani is assigned to Stonebridge Works, line P1. The current material specification uses a spun copper bowl, an aluminium frame, a synthetic membrane and a balanced pedal-linkage assembly. Incoming material is identified before it reaches the bench. A supplier description alone is not an acceptance record: the workshop checks the features relevant to this family and records the batch that entered the instrument. Finish and cosmetic matching happen later, after the parts have passed their structural checks.

The route has six named stages, and their order is part of the manufacturing record. At spin copper bowl, the technician must measure bowl depth and wall thickness. At machine support rim, the technician must inspect bearing contact around the full rim. At assemble frame, the technician must check linkage pivots without head load. At fit membrane, the technician must equalize tension at every lug. At balance pedal, the technician must match cartridge setting to the fitted membrane. At check pitch hold, the technician must record thirty-second holds after the settling sequence. A later stage cannot erase a missing earlier inspection. When a technician finds a problem, the traveller records which operation needs correction and which downstream checks must be repeated. That makes the route useful for a repair conversation as well as for production planning.

At balance pedal, the workshop establishes the player's working setup rather than simply making the instrument look finished. The technician must match cartridge setting to the fitted membrane. That operation is performed with the specified parts and accessories, not whatever happens to be available at the bench. A substitution is documented and evaluated as a substitution. It is not folded into the standard model record as though nothing changed.

The final route operation is check pitch hold. Its purpose is to expose a functional problem before packing, after the earlier operations have established the correct geometry. The workshop must record thirty-second holds after the settling sequence. A failure at this point returns the instrument to the relevant operation, followed by another complete final assessment. The route diagram later in this dossier shows that return path explicitly rather than hiding it behind a success-only production arrow.

The three current models use different direct bench-time allowances: 41 hours for Foundation, 63 for Atelier and 94 for TP-300 Roundwave. Those are synthetic planning figures for hands-on work, not calendar lead times. Conditioning, curing, settling, queueing and shipping can extend elapsed time substantially. A dealer cannot convert a forty-hour bench estimate into a promise of delivery within one working week.

The manufacturing record closes only when the serial, material batches, model revision and acceptance decision agree. The packing team receives a released instrument, not an open repair job. If a unit is held for rework, it remains physically separated from released stock and cannot be borrowed to fill a dealer order. That boundary preserves the meaning of the factory name and the quality claims attached to TP-300 Roundwave.

04 / QUALITY

Acceptance measures function, not prestige

The most useful quality question for the pedal timpani is whether it performs its intended function in a known condition. Aster Vale uses head-clearing, pedal-hold and pitch-settling checks. The family-specific acceptance rule is: less than 5 cents pitch drift during a thirty-second hold at each end of the specified range after head settling. These are invented workshop criteria for the synthetic catalogue, not an industry standard or independent certification. A released instrument has passed the documented route with the recorded setup; it has not been guaranteed to satisfy every possible player.

The recurring fault to watch for is pedal creep or uneven membrane tension around the rim. A cosmetic inspection can miss this problem, which is why the functional check is separate. When the defect is observed, the instrument is held for investigation. The technician records the symptom before adjusting parts, because an undocumented adjustment can remove evidence of the original cause and make a later recurrence harder to diagnose.

An instrument's response and its dimensional compliance are related but different. For this family, a light frame helps touring crews but must remain rigid enough to keep bowl support and pedal geometry consistent. The acceptance route controls the production condition; the player comparison controls suitability for a musical brief. That distinction helps explain why Petra Flint selected TP-300 Roundwave for the fictional 2024 Roundwave festival without implying that every Foundation instrument is defective or every flagship is automatically the right choice.

The nominal mass of the current configurations is 28 kg for Foundation, 29 kg for Atelier and 30 kg for TP-300 Roundwave. These catalogue figures exclude the transport case and accessories. They are not the force applied in a test or the shipping weight billed

by a carrier. Material variation can affect an individual unit, so lifting and transport decisions use the actual instrument and case rather than a rounded catalogue value alone.

In the synthetic 2025 service record, this family shipped 79 units and logged 2 90-day service returns from that shipment cohort. A service return means an instrument was presented for assessment within ninety days of dispatch. This observation window is closed for the full 2025 cohort by this edition. It does not mean every return was a manufacturing defect or include future repairs. Returns can include setup requests, transport damage or wear.

Do not use the rising shipment curve as proof that sound quality improved. Shipments reflect orders and capacity, while the return record reflects a defined service observation window. The chart and its definitions are separate from the acceptance criteria. To assess a particular instrument, request the serial-specific release record, repeat the family check and compare the observed symptom with the documented setup before making a repair or warranty decision.

05 / OWNERSHIP

Choose, maintain and service a known configuration

Choose a pedal timpani by starting with the musical and practical brief. Ask whether the instrument must support a pitch change that settles quickly without a pedal creeping back, whether it will travel regularly and who will maintain it. The three current configurations are TP-100 Foundation, TP-200 Atelier and TP-300 Roundwave. Their synthetic euro list prices are EUR 3,900, EUR 6,400 and EUR 9,400, respectively. These prices exclude tax, transport, cases and optional accessories, and are not offers from a real seller.

Foundation provides the shared operating geometry with the shortest individual fitting allowance. Atelier adds time for matching and adjustment. The 300-series flagship receives the most extended final assessment and the documented flagship configuration. All three have the nominal head diameter (mm) of 660. The specification table should be read by model row: a price from one row must not be combined with the mass or bench hours from another.

Before taking delivery, compare the instrument identity with the release record and inspect it with the dealer. Look for pedal creep or uneven membrane tension around the rim, while recognizing that some causes require the specialist checks described earlier. Ask the dealer to demonstrate the relevant functional test rather than assuming an unmarked exterior proves acceptance. Record the agreed setup so that a later service discussion begins from a known condition instead of an impression formed after transport.

The routine care instruction is specific: Cover the head when idle, release transport locks only after positioning and ask a percussion technician to change balance-cartridge settings. It supports stable use but does not authorize invasive repair. A player should stop when a part binds, a joint moves unexpectedly or a response changes abruptly.

Continued force can turn an adjustable problem into structural damage. Contact the dealer or an appropriate instrument technician and describe the observed symptom, the recent conditions and any changes in accessories.

The principal supported service operations are head replacement and pedal-balance calibration. A service request includes the serial, model revision, date of observation and a concise account of the symptom. Mention whether the instrument has travelled, changed climate or received a different setup. Do not describe a presumed internal cause as an established diagnosis. The technician compares the symptom with the original acceptance condition before deciding which part of the production or service route to revisit.

The fictional standard warranty lasts 24 months from dealer handover and covers confirmed manufacturing defects. Wear items, routine regulation, accidental damage and unapproved modifications are excluded. A 90-day service return in the infographic is therefore not automatically a warranty claim. The dealer documents the assessment outcome and explains the proposed work before authorization. The instrument remains the owner's property during assessment; a workshop hold is not a transfer of ownership.

06 / VISIBLE CONSTRUCTION

Identify parts before discussing service



Figure 2. Generated external view with authored leader arrows. Labels identify visible parts; no internal structure, tolerances or scale should be inferred.

The external view complements the operating description: a pedal changes membrane tension over a resonant bowl, shifting pitch while the head and bowl shape the decay. The actual material specification is a spun copper bowl, an aluminium frame, a synthetic membrane and a balanced pedal-linkage assembly.

For a service discussion, describe the observed symptom before proposing a diagnosis. The recurring fault in this family is pedal creep or uneven membrane tension around the rim. The corresponding bench check is head-clearing, pedal-hold and pitch-settling checks.

07 / COMMERCIAL AND TECHNICAL RECORDS

Read the model row, then the trend

Current full-size model specifications / synthetic catalogue values

Model	Head diameter (mm)	Mass (kg)	Bench hours	List EUR
TP-100 Foundation	660	28.00	41	3,900
TP-200 Atelier	660	29.00	63	6,400
TP-300 Roundwave	660	30.00	94	9,400

Mass excludes case and accessories. Bench hours are direct labour, not elapsed delivery time. Prices are fictional euro list prices excluding tax, transport and accessories.

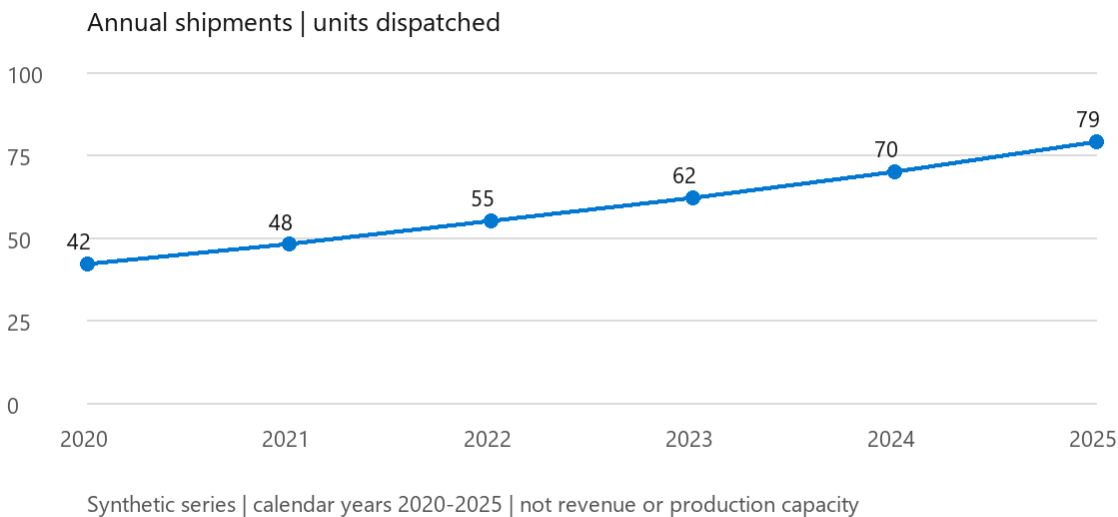


Figure 3. Raster chart for image-reading exercises. The horizontal axis is calendar year; the vertical axis is units dispatched, not euro revenue or factory capacity.

79

Units dispatched in 2025
One instrument family

2

90-day service returns
2025 shipment cohort

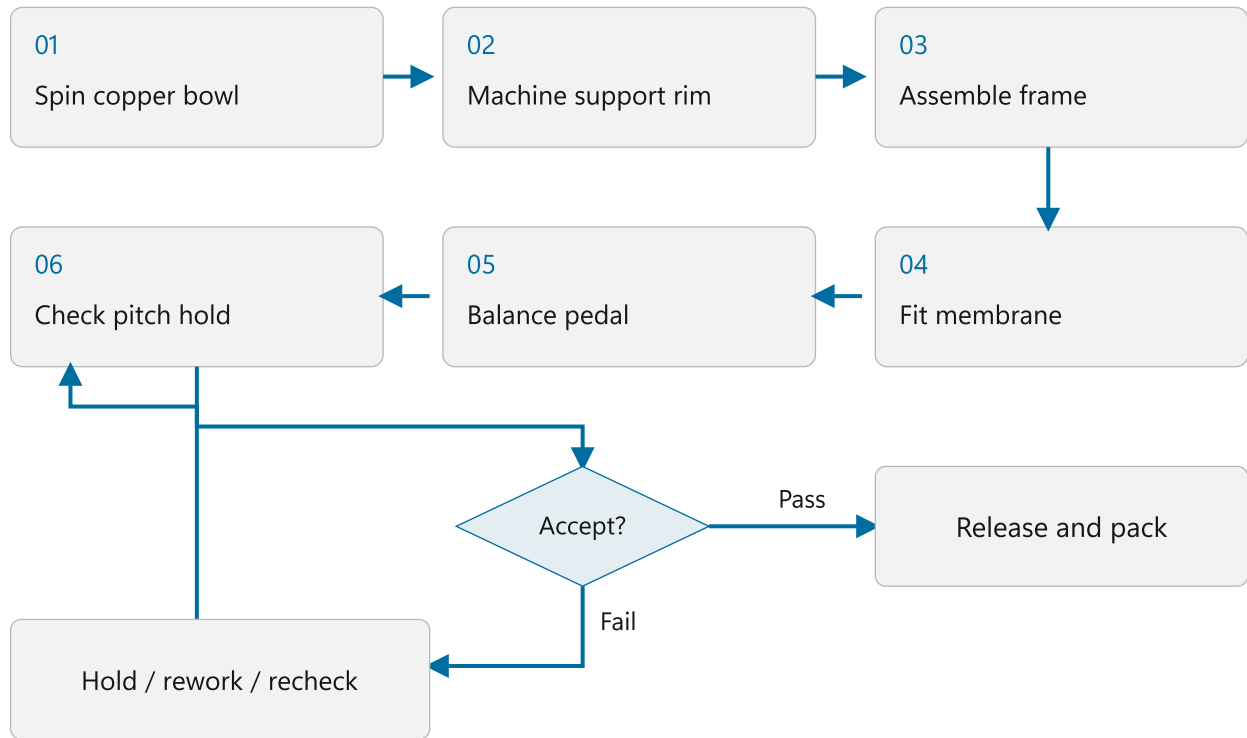
24

Warranty months
Confirmed manufacturing defects

All figures are synthetic. A service return includes assessment requests and is not necessarily a manufacturing defect or an approved warranty claim. A rising shipment line does not prove better sound quality.

08 / MANUFACTURING CONTROL

A failed check never flows into dispatch



Rework repeats the affected operation and every downstream check.

Figure 4. Authored process diagram. Follow the numbered operations, then read both branches of the acceptance decision. A hold is not a release.

Release criterion

less than 5 cents pitch drift during a thirty-second hold at each end of the specified range after head settling. The responsible location is Stonebridge Works, line P1.

Repair the cause and repeat the checks

Return to the affected operation, correct or replace the part, then repeat every downstream check including final acceptance. Record the serial, revision and decision. Keep held instruments apart from released stock.

Choose service over force

Cover the head when idle, release transport locks only after positioning and ask a percussion technician to change balance-cartridge settings. Supported specialist work includes head replacement and pedal-balance calibration.